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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SUNDAY, 04 OCTOBER 2026

15 must-know stories, 24 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 542 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Will bring laws against love, land jihad in 6 months, implement UCC like Uttarakhand, Gujarat: Adhikari

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari stated that his government will bring stringent laws against love jihad and land jihad within six months. He announced that the state will implement a Uniform Civil Code following the path of Uttarakhand and Gujarat. The announcements were made at an event in Kolkata marking the birth centenary of former VHP president Ashok Singhal. Adhikari emphasized that while the government will function as per the Constitution, it will not tolerate attacks on Indian culture, traditions, and places of worship. A high-level committee headed by former Supreme Court judge Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai has been constituted to examine a draft UCC for the state. The proposed West Bengal UCC Bill aims to standardise civil laws regarding marriage, divorce, inheritance, and adoption across all communities. The Chief Minister also announced a Rs 1,000 crore religious tourism circuit project to be completed in two years. Other upcoming events mentioned include a mass Gita recital by 10 lakh people and preparations for an international standard Gangasagar Mela.

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** Kolkata, West Bengal · **Who:** Suvendu Adhikari, Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai · **Prelims:** The high-level committee for examining the draft UCC in West Bengal is headed by Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.; The religious tourism circuit project in West Bengal has been earmarked with Rs 1,000 crore.; A mass Gita recital of 10 lakh people is scheduled for December 29.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the ongoing policy push by certain states to adopt a Uniform Civil Code independently.; Reflects shifts in regional governance priorities concerning religious and cultural standardization.*

Static — Article 44 of the Indian Constitution directs the State to secure for the citizens a Uniform Civil Code throughout the territory of India as part of the Directive Principles of State Policy. Uniform Civil Code refers to a single law for all citizens relating to personal matters such as marriage, divorce, inheritance, and adoption, replacing separate personal laws based on religious customs. Uttarakhand was among the first states in India to pass a legislation implementing a Uniform Civil Code following committee recommendations.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on deccanherald.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Upholds Appellant Mothers in Habeas Corpus Compensation Case for Custodial Disappearance. Army Officers Failed to Rebut Inquiry Finding that Detainees Were Not Released, Leading to Award of Rs.1,25,000 Each Under Article 32.

The Supreme Court delivered a verdict upholding the appellant mothers in a habeas corpus compensation case for custodial disappearance. The Supreme Court ruled in favor of appellant mothers in a habeas corpus compensation case, awarding them Rs.1,25,000 each after army officers failed to rebut findings that detainees were never released.

When: 2026-10-04 · **Who:** Supreme Court, Appellant Mothers, Army Officers · **Prelims:** Compensation awarded: Rs.1,25,000 each.; Constitutional provision used: Article 32.; Nature of case: Habeas corpus compensation for custodial disappearance.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces judicial accountability for security forces in cases of custodial disappearance.; Demonstrates the practical application of Article 32 in providing constitutional remedies.*

Static — Article 32 of the Constitution of India provides the right to constitutional remedies, allowing individuals to move the Supreme Court for the enforcement of fundamental rights. A writ of habeas corpus is a crucial legal remedy used to secure the release of a person who has been detained unlawfully or without legal justification. The Supreme Court and High Courts under Articles 32 and 226 respectively can award monetary compensation to victims of state excess and custodial violence.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Defence · Prelims angle: Judgment, Award

Lawtext: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Centre overhauls Tribunal appointment system

The Central Government notified a new framework for appointments and oversight of major tribunals under the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2026. The rules mandate that the process to fill tribunal vacancies must begin at least six months in advance of them arising. Ministries and departments must send requisitions for upcoming vacancies occurring during a calendar year to the National Tribunals Commission secretariat. Search-cum-Selection Committees will evaluate candidates through structured assessments, including scrutiny of judicial work, professional experience, and order-writing exercises. Assessments will examine knowledge of procedural and substantive law, legal reasoning, judicial temperament, analytical ability, and drafting skills. For every vacancy, the selection committee will recommend one suitable candidate and one waitlist name valid for one year within three working days. The Central Government remains the final appointing authority for the tribunal chairpersons and members. The Commission's secretariat will maintain a database of members, operate an online application portal, and develop a National Tribunals Data Grid. The notification prescribes specific qualifications for appointments to key bodies like the CAT, SAT, DRT, NGT, and NCLAT.

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Ministry of Law and Justice's Department of Legal Affairs · **Prelims:** The rules are called the National Tribunals Commission and Qualification, Selection and Conditions of Service of Chairperson and Members of Tribunals Rules, 2026.; The selection committee must communicate recommendations to the Central Government within three working days.; The waitlist recommended by the selection committee remains valid for one year.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Introduces structured candidate evaluation, including order-writing tests and judgment scrutiny, to improve tribunal quality.; Mandates advance planning by starting vacancy filling processes at least six months ahead to reduce administrative delays.*

Static — Tribunals are quasi-judicial bodies established under the Constitution or statutes to reduce the burden on courts and adjudicate specialized disputes. Articles 323A and 323B were introduced in the Constitution by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976, enabling the creation of administrative and other tribunals. The Supreme Court in landmark judgments like Madras Bar Association v. Union of India has repeatedly emphasized judicial independence and proper tenure for tribunal members.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Appointment

msn.com: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Legislative Privilege vs Press Freedom: Supreme Court’s Constitutional Test

The intervention application was filed before the Supreme Court in the ongoing legislative privileges reference case. Digital media outlet The News Minute has sought to intervene in a Supreme Court reference concerning legislative privileges, arguing they should not be used to restrict press freedom. Legislative Privilege Latest News The Supreme Court began hearing a long-pending reference on the scope of legislative privileges — the special powers and immunities enjoyed by Parliament and state legislatures to protect their functioning. The central question: can these privileges, under Articles 105 and 194 of the Constitution, be invoked against citizens and journalists, and can they override fundamental rights like freedom of speech under Article 19? A seven-judge Constitution Bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, is hearing the matter. The Legal Framework at Stake Article 194(3) : Grants state legislatures certain privileges and immunities to protect their functioning…

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** The News Minute, Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The News Minute filed an intervention application in the Supreme Court.; The case involves a presidential reference on legislative privileges.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the ongoing tension between legislative immunity and journalistic freedom in India.; Crucial for defining the constitutional limits of legislative privilege vis-a-vis media scrutiny.*

Static — Legislative privileges are special rights and immunities enjoyed by Houses of Parliament and state legislatures, and their members, to effectively discharge their functions. Article 105 of the Constitution deals with the powers and privileges of Parliament, while Article 194 deals with those of state legislatures. Prior to the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act 1978, these privileges were equated with those of the British House of Commons.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

'Strikes At Heart Of Constitution': Top Court Judge On Mass Deletion Of Voters

Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan stated that mass disenfranchisement of Indian citizens is intrinsically arbitrary and negates the constitutional order. Speaking at NALSAR University of Law in Hyderabad, Bhuyan asserted that no amount of whataboutery can justify taking away voting rights. He warned that wholesale disenfranchisement strikes at the heart of the Constitution and violates Articles 326 and 14. Bhuyan emphasized that except for deceased voters, a name cannot be removed from electoral rolls without notice and a hearing. He noted that while the right to vote is a constitutional right rather than a fundamental one, it is central to the basic structure doctrine. The judge connected the right to vote directly to India's independence struggle and sacrifices against foreign rule. He highlighted the principle of political equality, noting that a billionaire and a rickshaw puller hold votes of equal value.

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** Hyderabad · **Who:** Justice Ujjal Bhuyan · **Prelims:** Justice Ujjal Bhuyan is a judge of the Supreme Court of India.; The speech was delivered at NALSAR University of Law in Hyderabad.; Articles cited in the speech regarding disenfranchisement include Article 326 and Article 14.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reiterates the judiciary's stance on protecting universal adult suffrage and political equality in Indian democracy.; Highlights procedural safeguards, mandating notice and a hearing before any voter's name is deleted from electoral rolls.*

Static — Article 326 of the Constitution provides for elections to the House of the People and to the Legislative Assemblies of States to be based on adult suffrage. Article 14 of the Constitution guarantees equality before the law and equal protection of the laws within the territory of India. The right to vote in India is a constitutional right derived from statutory provisions and Article 326, rather than being a fundamental right under Part III.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

NDTV: read the source · free copy on nationalheraldindia.com · also reported by lawchakra.in, ETV Bharat, The Hindu, Times of India, Bar & Bench

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Upholds State Authority in Medical Admissions — Clarifies Legislative Powers on Eligibility and Reservations.

The Supreme Court delivered a ruling clarifying state legislative powers on medical admissions and reservations. The Supreme Court upheld state authority in medical admissions, clarifying legislative powers regarding eligibility and reservations.

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the legislative competence of states in framing medical admission policies.; Impacts the implementation of state-specific reservation and eligibility criteria.*

Static — Education falls under the Concurrent List of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, allowing both Parliament and State Legislatures to make laws. Entry 66 of List I empowers the Union to maintain standards in higher education and research, which often intersects with state powers under Entry 25 of List III. The Supreme Court has previously established through landmark judgments like T.M.A. Pai Foundation and Modern Dental College that states can regulate admissions to ensure social justice.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Lawtext: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Shivraj Singh Chouhan Hands Over 3 Lakh Houses Worth Rs. 3,600 Crore to Andhra Pradesh, Lays Foundation for India’s First 3D Concrete-Printed Housing Project

Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan handed over the first instalment for three lakh houses worth Rs. 3,600 crore to Andhra Pradesh under PMAY-Gramin 2.0. The event took place in Guntur district in the presence of Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu. Following a request by the Chief Minister, the housing allocation was increased from the initially proposed 76,000 to 3 lakh houses. The Union Minister also laid the foundation stone for India's first pilot housing project using 3D concrete printing technology. The 3D printing pilot project will construct 177 houses at Burripalem and Obulnayudupalem at a cost of Rs. 14 crore. The innovative 3D housing project aims to reduce construction time, costs, and labour requirements while offering greater durability. The Centre also committed to supporting rural infrastructure works in Andhra Pradesh under the Vikasit Bharat-G RAM G scheme.

When: October 4, 2026 · **Where:** Guntur district, Andhra Pradesh · **Who:** Shivraj Singh Chouhan, N. Chandrababu Naidu · **Prelims:** 3 lakh houses worth Rs. 3,600 crore were handed over under PMAY-Gramin 2.0.; India's first 3D concrete-printed housing project comprises 177 houses at a cost of Rs. 14 crore.; The 3D housing project is located in Burripalem and Obulnayudupalem of Guntur district.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Accelerates rural housing delivery and fulfills the objective of housing for all in Andhra Pradesh.; Introduces cutting-edge 3D concrete printing technology to revolutionise traditional Indian construction practices.*

Static — Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G) is a flagship housing scheme implemented by the Ministry of Rural Development to provide pucca houses with basic amenities to rural poor. The scheme aims to bridge the housing deficit in rural areas and ensure housing for all by leveraging technology and financial assistance. 3D concrete printing technology uses computer-controlled machinery to deposit construction material layer by layer, significantly reducing construction time and labour.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Infrastructure & Energy, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in · also reported by The Hindu

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, US discuss advancing security partnership, maritime cooperation in Indo-Pacific

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar met US Pacific Command Commander Admiral Samuel J. Paparo in New Delhi. The high-level meeting occurred during Admiral Paparo's six-day official visit to strengthen bilateral defence ties. Discussions focused on advancing the India-US security partnership and enhancing maritime cooperation in the Indo-Pacific. US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor was present during the bilateral talks. Both sides reviewed shared security priorities including regional strategic stability and emerging technologies. Additional focus areas included digital transformation, defence energy resilience, and navigating competitive technological landscapes. Earlier, Chief of Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth met US Army Pacific Deputy Commanding General Joel B. Vowell. The military leadership reviewed interoperability and noted the successful outcome of Exercise Yudh Abhyas.

When: September 28 to October 4, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** S. Jaishankar (EAM), Admiral Samuel J. Paparo (US Pacific Command Commander), Sergio Gor (US Ambassador to India), General Dhiraj Seth (COAS), and Lt. Gen. Joel B. Vowell · **Prelims:** Admiral Samuel J. Paparo serves as the Commander of the US Pacific Command.; Exercise Yudh Abhyas is a bilateral joint military exercise conducted between the Indian Army and the US Army.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens joint operational synergy and interoperability between Indian armed forces and US commands.; Enhances maritime domain awareness and strategic balance across the broader Indo-Pacific architecture.*

Static — India and the US share a 'Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership' elevated by the Major Defence Partner designation granted in 2016. Foundational defence pacts signed include GSOMIA (2002), LEMOA (2016), COMCASA (2018), and BECA (2020) for intelligence sharing and logistics support. The 2+2 Ministerial Dialogue serves as the premier mechanism involving foreign and defence ministers of both nations.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on thehansindia.com · also reported by zeebiz.com, The Hindu

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India moves beyond advocacy towards Russia-Ukraine war resolution: EAM

External affairs minister S Jaishankar stated that India has moved beyond traditional advocacy to actively broker peace and operational agreements between Russia and Ukraine. The ongoing conflict has stretched on for more than four years, prompting India to hold direct conversations with both warring nations to end hostilities. India is attempting to be helpful on specific operational issues, starting with Black Sea shipping safety, grain exports, energy exports, and non-attack possibilities. This shift follows a meeting of the consultative committee of the ministry of external affairs on India-Russia relations reviewing New Delhi's active engagement with Moscow and Kyiv. Ukrainian foreign minister Andrii Sybiha confirmed that Kyiv is evaluating four international peace proposals and considers India's proposal the most comprehensive. Russian President Vladimir Putin also praised Prime Minister Narendra Modi's efforts and acknowledged that the Indian leader has good ideas for a peaceful resolution. Prime Minister Modi has consistently maintained a principled and humanitarian approach, emphasizing that dialogue and diplomacy remain the only viable paths to peace.

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** Munich, Russia, Ukraine, New Delhi · **Who:** S Jaishankar, Vladimir Putin, Narendra Modi, Andrii Sybiha · **Prelims:** Ukrainian foreign minister Andrii Sybiha stated that Kyiv is reviewing four international proposals including submissions from Turkey, Egypt, the US, and India.; Russian President Vladimir Putin praised PM Narendra Modi's efforts to help bring an end to the conflict.; External affairs minister S Jaishankar made the announcement during the Munich leaders meeting.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reflects India's growing diplomatic clout and willingness to take on an active mediatory role in major international conflicts.; Demonstrates the success of India's strategic autonomy, maintaining energy security while earning praise from both Moscow and Kyiv.*

Static — India maintains a time-tested and strategic partnership with Russia, spanning defence, energy, nuclear cooperation, and transit connectivity projects like the International North-South Transport Corridor. At the same time, India shares robust diplomatic, economic, and technological ties with Western nations and Ukraine, enabling a unique independent foreign policy posture. India's traditional foreign policy doctrine emphasizes strategic autonomy, non-alignment, and the peaceful resolution of international disputes through dialogue and diplomacy.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: read the source · also reported by The Hindu

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST exemption for banks, nominated agencies for gold, silver imports may be withdrawn

The GST Council is likely to consider a proposal to withdraw the Integrated GST exemption on gold, silver, and platinum imports by banks and nominated agencies. Currently, precious metal imports are subject to a 3 per cent IGST, but this tax is exempt for specified banks and government-listed nominated agencies. The upcoming GST Council meeting on October 7 will evaluate removing this tax exemption that was initially granted in 2017 to facilitate trade under canalised regulations. The removal of this exemption will place bullion exchanges and nominated agencies on an equal footing regarding taxation. Gold, silver, and precious metal imports are a government concern due to foreign currency outflows and their negative impact on India's foreign exchange reserves. India remains the world's second-largest gold consumer behind China, with imports largely driven by domestic jewellery industry demand. In May, the government increased import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent and platinum to 15.4 per cent to restrict non-essential imports. Gold imports grew by 3.38 per cent to USD 17.47 billion between April and August 2026-27, whereas silver imports dropped by 8.81 per cent to USD 1.74 billion.

When: October 7, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** GST Council, banks, nominated agencies · **Prelims:** India is the world's second-largest gold consumer after China.; Gold imports during April-August 2026-27 grew by 3.38 per cent to USD 17.47 billion.; Silver imports during April-August 2026-27 declined by 8.81 per cent to USD 1.74 billion.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Aligns taxation for bullion exchanges and nominated agencies to ensure a level playing field.; Aims to check foreign currency outflows and protect India's foreign exchange reserves from mounting import bills.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A of the Constitution of India, chaired by the Union Finance Minister with state finance ministers as members. Integrated GST is levied on all inter-state supplies of goods and services and on all imports of goods and services into India under the IGST Act, 2017. Nominated agencies for importing precious metals include specified public sector banks, scheduled banks, and trading houses notified by the Reserve Bank of India or the Directorate General of Foreign Trade.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST Council may clear sweeping compliance reforms; e-commerce sellers, genuine buyers to get relief

The GST Council is considering sweeping process reforms under GST 2.0 to make tax compliance easier for businesses. Proposals include allowing small e-commerce sellers to use platform warehouses for GST registration in states where they lack premises. This move could enable around 9.5 lakh small sellers to access the national market without establishing physical offices. The Council may protect the input tax credit of genuine buyers with valid invoices even if upstream suppliers default. To cut litigation, the Council may bar GST notices for tax demands below Rs 10,000, which make up 20 per cent of cases. Tax officers would have to send a prior intimation and allow a response before issuing formal notices for demands above Rs 10,000. Other proposals include intelligence-led transit checks, a single 5 per cent GST rate on e-commerce goods deliveries without ITC, and simpler MSME returns. Centre and state GST officers working groups have met over eight times to firm up these reforms focused on ease of compliance.

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** GST Council, Rajat Mohan · **Prelims:** Around 9.5 lakh small sellers could benefit from e-commerce warehouse registration provisions.; Tax demands below Rs 10,000 account for about 20 per cent of all cases by number.; A single 5 per cent GST rate without input tax credit is proposed for delivery of goods ordered through e-commerce platforms.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces litigation burden by barring small tax demands and addressing upstream supplier default issues.; Boosts e-commerce participation for 9.5 lakh small sellers by simplifying multi-state registrations.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A of the Constitution of India. It is chaired by the Union Finance Minister and includes state finance ministers as members, deciding issues on indirect tax matters through consensus. Input Tax Credit (ITC) allows businesses to claim credit for taxes paid on raw materials and business inputs against the tax payable on final output.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by Business Standard, Mint, Indian Express, BusinessLine

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s Rising Supercomputing Ecosystem

A PIB backgrounder highlighted India's growing supercomputing capabilities, indigenous technology development, and applications across various sectors. India's supercomputing ecosystem has expanded significantly under the National Supercomputing Mission, deploying 40 supercomputers delivering 68 PF as of September 2026 and developing indigenous hardware and software technologies. India’s supercomputing journey has evolved from PARAM 8000 in the early 1990s to a national ecosystem under the National Supercomputing Mission (NSM), launched in 2015. With 40 supercomputers delivering 68 PF as of September 2026, NSM is expanding access to high-performance computing (HPC). The Mission has also developed indigenous servers, software, cooling and networking technologies, while supporting applications in Computational Biology, Weather Prediction and Climate Modelling, Disaster Management, Big Data Analytics, and Astrophysics. Building India’s Supercomputing Capabilities From predicting crop yields and tracking disease outbreaks to accelerating drug discovery and predicting aff

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** India · **Who:** National Supercomputing Mission · **Prelims:** India's first major supercomputing milestone was PARAM 8000 in the early 1990s.; The National Supercomputing Mission (NSM) was launched in 2015.; As of September 2026, India has 40 supercomputers delivering 68 PF.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Boosts India's scientific research and technological innovation by processing massive datasets efficiently.; Aids critical societal applications like weather forecasting, disaster management, crop yield prediction, and healthcare.*

Static — Supercomputers are high-performance computing systems designed to process complex calculations at exceptional speeds by combining large numbers of processors to run simultaneous operations. The National Supercomputing Mission (NSM) was launched in 2015 to empower national academic and R&D institutions by installing a vast supercomputing grid. PARAM 8000, developed in the early 1990s, marked India's first major milestone in indigenous supercomputing development.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Disaster Management, Health · Prelims angle: Scheme

PIB: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Explain how the India Semiconductor Mission can reduce import dependencies. Critically analyze the financial and infrastructural challenges involved in scaling up domestic chip fabrication.

The India Semiconductor Mission aims to reduce import dependence by building domestic capacity across fabrication, assembly, compound semiconductors, and chip design. The mission provides financial incentives of up to 50 percent of project costs to help cut reliance on foreign chips and packaging services. Design-linked incentives are provided under the mission to encourage indigenous intellectual property and reduce dependence on foreign architectures. The mission also supports equipment, specialty materials, research and development, and talent to shift India from a buyer to a producer. A major challenge is that semiconductor fabs require multi-billion-dollar investments, long gestation periods, and patient capital while domestic financing remains limited. Infrastructure gaps include heavy dependence on imported wafers, gases, chemicals, and equipment, alongside a lack of adequate vendor ecosystems and skilled technicians.

Where: India · **Who:** India Semiconductor Mission · **Prelims:** Incentives offered under the India Semiconductor Mission cover up to 50 percent of project costs.; Semiconductor plants require reliable power, ultrapure water, cleanrooms, and precision logistics.; India currently depends heavily on imported wafers, gases, chemicals, and equipment.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps secure domestic supply chains against global semiconductor shortages and geopolitical disruptions.; Promotes high-value manufacturing and indigenous intellectual property creation under Atmanirbhar Bharat.*

Static — The India Semiconductor Mission was launched to build a vibrant semiconductor and display ecosystem to enable India's emergence as a global electronics hub. Semiconductor manufacturing requires highly capital-intensive fabrication units, cleanrooms, ultrapure water, and uninterrupted high-quality power supply. OSAT stands for Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test, which handles the packaging and testing of fabricated semiconductor wafers.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

gktoday.in: read the source · also reported by GKToday

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India successfully demonstrates its first free-space quantum-secure communication link for over 5.5 km

Indian deep-tech startup QNu Labs, BISAG-N, and IIT Gandhinagar demonstrated India's first free-space quantum key distribution link over 5.56 km. The field trial took place on the night of September 27-28, establishing a secure communication channel between BISAG-N and IIT-G. Free-space quantum key distribution shares secret digital passwords using light particles through open air or space rather than fibre-optic cables. Quantum mechanics principles ensure any interception attempt alters photon states, making it the most secure data-sending method. The trial achieved a stable quantum bit error rate below 5% and generated secure keys at a rate of 230 to 260 bps. Keys were integrated with BISAG-N's Vedic Kavach platform, enabling end-to-end encryption and decryption of test messages. The demonstration paves the way for longer-distance quantum-secure networks and future satellite-based quantum communication. The project strengthens India's indigenous capabilities in secure communication infrastructure against emerging quantum-era security threats.

When: September 27-28, 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** QNu Labs, BISAG-N, IIT Gandhinagar · **Prelims:** Distance of the demonstration: over 5.56 km; Quantum bit error rate achieved: below 5%; Secure key generation rate: 230–260 bps

> ***Why it matters —*** *It bypasses the limitations of signal loss inside traditional fibre-optic cables.; It forms a foundational bridge for transmitting keys between Earth and orbiting satellites.*

Static — Quantum Key Distribution uses principles of quantum mechanics to securely generate and distribute cryptographic keys between communicating parties. Free-space optics allow optical communication through open air, water, or difficult terrain where laying physical fibre cables is impractical. Quantum bit error rate measures the ratio of incorrectly received bits to the total transferred bits in a quantum communication system.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology

Times of India: read the source · also reported by The Hindu

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

As first Agniveer batch complete term, services suggest improvements to scheme

The first batch of Agniveers has finished its designated four-year term of service. The three military services have submitted recommendations to improve the Agniveer scheme as the first batch completes its four-year term. Army, Navy, Air Force have submitted recommendations based on four years of experience in implementing the Agniveer scheme; armed forces seek to balance need for younger force with operational experience and continuity

When: 2026-10-04 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Army, Navy, Air Force · **Prelims:** The first batch of Agniveers has completed their four-year term.; Recommendations were submitted by the Army, Navy, and Air Force.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides critical feedback from the ground on India's major military human resource reform.; Addresses the ongoing debate between maintaining a youthful profile and retaining experienced personnel.*

Static — The Agnipath scheme was introduced by the Union Government in 2022 for recruitment of soldiers into the Army, Navy, and Air Force. Agniveers are recruited for a period of four years, including six months of basic training, as part of a transformation to lower the average age profile of the armed forces. Up to 25 percent of each retiring batch of Agniveers are eligible for regular cadre enrollment based on merit and organizational requirements.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

The Hindu: read the source · also reported by SSBCrack

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

ECONOMY QUICK READ

RBI may hike rates by 0.25% in Oct policy amid inflation: Experts poll

The Reserve Bank of India is likely to increase the repo rate by 0.25 per cent in the October monetary policy review according to a poll of 16 economists and bankers. This expected move is driven by mounting inflationary pressures, the re-escalation of the West Asia crisis, and rate hikes by global central banks.

Economic Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Assam Cabinet approves 12 per cent reservation for ex-Agniveers in 11 categories of government jobs

The Assam State Cabinet decided to reserve 12 percent of constable posts for ex-Agniveers of the Indian Army across 11 categories of government jobs. The decision was taken under the chairmanship of Chief Minister Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma during a cabinet meeting on Sunday. The core issue is providing secure post-retirement employment opportunities for trained military personnel returning to their home states after four years of service.

sentinelassam.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

U'khand Cabinet clears 24 proposals, approves Rs 200 crore skill scheme, major rule changes

The cabinet meeting led to the clearance of these significant state policy and financial proposals. The Uttarakhand Cabinet approved 24 proposals, including a Rs 200 crore skill scheme and major administrative rule changes.

thehawk.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Andhra Pradesh ready for local body polls, awaiting SC verdict on BC quota: Narayana

The Andhra Pradesh government challenged a High Court verdict concerning 34 percent reservation for Backward Classes in local body elections. The state government decided to seek a hold on the election process until the Supreme Court delivers its final verdict. Municipal administration and urban development minister P Narayana stated that the government filed an appeal in the Supreme Court.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Bihar’s Ghatora Wetland Moves Toward Ramsar Recognition

The wetland made news because authorities announced that a formal proposal for its Ramsar recognition will be sent soon. Bihar's Ghatora Wetland has entered the formal recognition process to be designated as an internationally important Ramsar site.

Patna Press: source

DEFENCE | SPECIES | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

India, Mongolia conclude 18th 'Nomadic Elephant' military exercise

The 18th edition of the joint military exercise 'Nomadic Elephant' between the Indian and Mongolian armies concluded in Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand. The exercise commenced on September 20 to enhance interoperability, strengthen mutual understanding, and promote friendship and cooperation between the two armies. Training was conducted in three phases, starting with integration and familiarisation from September 20 to 23.

deccanchronicle.com: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | APPOINTMENT | QUICK READ

Protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar LIVE: Supreme Court to hear plea to suspend CEC from office

The Supreme Court is scheduled to hear petitions seeking the suspension of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the special intensive revision (SIR) exercise. The petitions were filed by Rakesh Kumar Singh and advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi amid a controversy regarding decisions allegedly taken without the consent of other Election Commissioners.

Hindustan Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

India, Canada to begin 5th round of talks for proposed economic partnership pact on Oct 5

Chief negotiators of India and Canada are set to begin the fifth round of negotiations for the proposed Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in Ottawa starting October 5. The five-day talks aim to conclude negotiations by the end of the calendar year, moving at a faster pace ahead of an expected visit by Prime Minister Narendra Modi to Canada.

BusinessLine: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

EU–India Pact Could Expand Bilateral Trade Far More Than EU-Wide Exports, IMF Study Finds

The study was published, bringing renewed attention to the potential economic impacts of an EU-India trade agreement. An IMF study reveals that a trade pact between the European Union and India could expand bilateral trade significantly more than general EU-wide exports.

The Policy Edge: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

Mandaviya Launches Physical Education Professionals Module on NSRS Portal

Union Youth Affairs and Sports Minister Dr Mansukh Mandaviya launched the Physical Education Professionals Module. The module was launched on the National Sports Repository System (NSRS) portal in New Delhi. The initiative aims to nurture sporting talents at the grassroots level and empower Physical Education teachers. The Minister urged all physical education professionals to register themselves on the NSRS portal.

newsonair.gov.in: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

MoRTH to Organise “Chintan Shivir 2026” to Shape Future-Ready, Safe and High-Quality Highway Infrastructure

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways is organizing Chintan Shivir 2026 on October 5-6 at Ekta Nagar in Gujarat. The conclave brings together central ministers, state road transport ministers, PWD officials, implementing agencies, and stakeholders to improve highway infrastructure. The event aims to foster Centre-State coordination and facilitate the exchange of field-level experiences and practical solutions.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

India, Chile struggle to clear critical-mineral hurdle in CEPA talks

The negotiations are struggling to clear the critical-mineral hurdle as a year-end deadline looms. India and Chile are facing obstacles in their Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) talks due to disagreements over critical minerals like copper and lithium. Year-end deadline looms as India seeks preferential access to copper, lithium, while Chile favours supply-chain cooperation and value-added exports

BusinessLine: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Wild tusker Chakkakompan uses cleared elephant passage to move to national park in Keralam’s Idukki

The successful movement of the wild elephant through the restored corridor brought it into the news. A wild tusker named Chakkakompan successfully used a cleared elephant passage to move into a national park in Keralam's Idukki district.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE QUICK READ

US Air Force F-35A fighter jets take to skies over Jodhpur during Tarang Shakti 2026

The US Air Force F-35A Lightning II fighter jets took to the skies over Jodhpur during joint training operations for Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026. The participation aims to strengthen interoperability, enhance operational coordination, and build partnerships through combined air operations. The core objective is to allow participating air forces to operate together, share experiences, and understand each other's operating philosophies.

tribuneindia.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY JUDGMENT REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

SC to hear suo motu case over relocation of 135-year-old Central Secretariat Library

The Supreme Court has taken suo motu cognisance of concerns regarding the proposed relocation of the 135-year-old Central Secretariat Library. The library is currently located in Shastri Bhawan in New Delhi, which is scheduled for demolition under the Central Vista redevelopment project. The core issue involves a dispute over inadequate space allocation, threatening the preservation and accessibility of a massive historical book collection.

Bar & Bench: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Uttarakhand to repeal, replace British-era irrigation law

The Uttarakhand Cabinet decided to repeal the 153-year-old Northern India Canal and Drainage Act, 1873. The colonial law is being replaced by the newly formulated Uttarakhand Irrigation and Drainage Bill, 2026. The cabinet meeting was chaired by Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami at the NHPC complex in Banbasa, Champawat district. This marked the first time a state cabinet meeting was held in Champawat, the chief minister's constituency.

theprint.in: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Govt raises deepwater gas price ceiling to $9.89 per MMBtu, APM cap at $7

The government raised the ceiling price for natural gas from difficult fields to USD 9.89 per MMBtu for the six months starting October 1. The ceiling price was increased from USD 8.90 previously for deepwater, ultra-deepwater and high-pressure, high-temperature discoveries like the KG-D6 block. The ceiling for gas from legacy fields of state-run ONGC and Oil India Ltd was kept unchanged at USD 7 per MMBtu.

Business Standard: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Looking forward to QUAD FMM: EAM on meeting with Australian FM Wong; discusses Strategic Partnership with Philippines’ counterpart

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar met Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong and Philippines Foreign Secretary Ma Theresa P Lazaro in Manila. The meetings were held ahead of the Quad Foreign Ministers Meeting and various ASEAN-related ministerial engagements. Discussions with the Philippines focused on expanding the Strategic Partnership across trade, defence, maritime cooperation, and capacity building.

ddnews.gov.in: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | REPORT/INDEX | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Iran says Strait of Hormuz will not reopen until conditions are met, says reports

Iran stated that the Strait of Hormuz will remain closed until the United States fulfills seven conditions tied to a June agreement. The trigger was a U.S. response delivered through Qatari intermediaries last week following an Iranian proposal presented at the United Nations General Assembly. At stake is the resumption of normal maritime passage through the crucial waterway and global energy security.

The Hindu: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

G20 Trade Talks End Without Agreement on China-Linked Issues

The G20 trade talks ended without consensus on China-linked issues. G20 trade ministerial talks concluded without a joint agreement due to divisions over China-linked issues.

News of Bahrain: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | QUICK READ

LS Speaker Om Birla reconstitutes several Parliamentary Committees

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla has reconstituted several parliamentary committees related to different ministries with terms effective from 26th of last month. BJP MP Bhartruhari Mahtab has been appointed as the chairperson of the Committee on Finance, which has 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha members.

newsonair.gov.in: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | QUICK READ

Farmers can apply until October 24 to sell groundnut, moong, soybean and Urad at MSP: Gujarat Agriculture Minister

Gujarat Agriculture Minister announced that farmers can now apply until October 24 to sell specific Kharif crops at Minimum Support Price. The state government extended the registration period by 15 days following favourable representations received from MPs, MLAs, and farmer representatives. The core issue involves facilitating farmer access to MSP procurement for key oilseeds and pulses through digital registration channels.

aninews.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

SC/ST Act After CJI Surya Kant's Refusal: A Law That Presumes Guilt Needs Review

The piece was reported following remarks or a refusal by CJI Surya Kant concerning aspects of the Act. An editorial commentary examines the legal debates surrounding the SC/ST Act, focusing on statutory provisions that presume guilt and the need for judicial review.

LawChakra: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Top 5 Supreme Court Judgments Of September 2026

It appeared as a legal news update regarding judgments delivered by the Supreme Court. The source text mentions a compilation of the top 5 Supreme Court judgments of September 2026.

Live Law: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 GS3 Next-gen GST and India's next phase of growth

The Union Finance Minister stated that Next-Gen GST rate rationalisation in force since September 2025 has widened reported economic activity without weakening tax revenue. A second round of process reforms covering registration, returns, refunds, disputes, and input tax credit goes before the GST Council on October 7. The core debate is whether lower tax rates can expand economic activity enough to keep revenue growing while easing compliance.

BusinessLine

GS3 RBI MPC: beginning of a short and calibrated hike cycle

It is in the news ahead of the upcoming Reserve Bank of India Monetary Policy Committee meeting. The editorial anticipates a 25 basis point rate hike by the RBI Monetary Policy Committee in October, accompanied by a shift from a neutral stance to a data-dependent approach. One expects the monetary policy committee to deliver a rate hike in October, but a calibrated 25 basis points, along with a change in the hitherto 'neutral' stance and guidance for a data-dependent policy response in the coming months.

Mint

GS3 A test for forward guidance in monetary policy

It is in the news due to the evolving economic environment and the critical role of central bank communication. An opinion piece analyzing the challenges and importance of forward guidance by the Monetary Policy Committee in navigating complex economic conditions. Given the complex set of dynamic considerations, the MPC's communication will be keenly watched

BusinessLine

GS3 RBI MPC must raise rates as inflation and external risks rise

An editorial arguing that the RBI Monetary Policy Committee should raise interest rates to counter mounting inflation and external risks. India's economy is currently thriving, boasting a growth rate exceeding 7%, bolstered by diverse sectors and enhancing productivity levels. Nonetheless, escalating oil prices and geopolitical instability present significant threats to economic stability and rising inflation. The Reserve Bank of India faces calls to increase interest rates to effectively address inflationary pressures.

Economic Times

GS2 A confrontation that reshaped the Election Commission

The editorial reflects on past institutional clashes involving the Election Commission. An editorial discussing a historical confrontation that reshaped the structure and powers of the Election Commission.

Indian Express

GS2 Electoral rolls and voting rights: it's time for India to revisit its founding debates and the ECI's evolution

Current anxieties surrounding electoral roll revision have brought focus back to voting rights, the Election Commission, and India's constitutional history. An opinion piece discussing the need to revisit Constituent Assembly debates on universal adult franchise and the evolution of the Election Commission amidst electoral roll revision anxiety. The country must recall debates in the Constituent Assembly that framed the Constitution and why it settled on universal adult franchise. The judiciary's role in strengthening the election process is significant too.

Mint

GS2 Essential rereading: Umadevi at 20

The article marks the twentieth anniversary of the landmark Umadevi ruling by the Supreme Court. The text is an opinion piece written by a practising lawyer with expertise in disability rights and IP law, and co-founder of Mission Accessibility. The author examines how the Supreme Court has engaged with the intent of the original Umadevi judgment over the past twenty years. The original Umadevi ruling deals with matters of public employment, regularization, and temporary or contractual workers.

Deccan Herald

GS3 China is building a tech empire

It was featured as an opinion piece in the Deccan Herald highlighting global technological shifts. The editorial discusses how China is systematically building a dominant global technology empire. China is building a tech empire

Deccan Herald

GS3 India's AI strategy: We should not invest in the whole stack but focus instead on areas of expertise

It appeared as an opinion piece addressing how Indian policymakers should shape the country's national artificial intelligence strategy. The editorial argues that India should avoid investing in the entire expensive artificial intelligence stack and instead concentrate resources on areas of national expertise. The artificial intelligence (AI) stack is both complex and expensive. As Indian policymakers try to put India on the global AI map, it would be better for the country to focus on maximizing value where it can instead of spreading resources thin.

Mint

GS3 AI in insurance: Next competitive advantage will come from better data

Most insurers run multiple AI pilots for claims, fraud, underwriting, and customer service, but many programmes fail to scale despite heavy investments. The primary bottleneck for insurance AI is not model sophistication, but severe data fragmentation across legacy systems that cannot communicate. According to a 2025 FSI forum survey, data quality was cited by 55% of financial and insurance organisations as their number one implementation challenge.

Hindustan Times

GS2 Cultural explanations for geopolitical behaviour have long been scoffed at—but they offer insights today

The editorial argues that cultural explanations for geopolitical behaviour, long dismissed by analysts, now provide valuable insights during times of heightened uncertainty. Its study has evolved as a discipline over the past two decades. It may help improve our understanding of world affairs for policymakers to make better informed choices.

Mint

GS3 In Maharashtra, the story of a drought foretold

Maharashtra is confronting a severe water shortage after a weak monsoon, with Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis warning it could surpass the historic 1972 drought. Unlike the 1972 crisis caused by three successive failed monsoons, today just one bad season has plunged the state into trouble despite full reservoirs last year. The 1972 drought led leaders like V.S. Page and opposition leader Krishnarao Dhulap to create the Employment Guarantee Scheme via a tax increase.

msn.com

GS1 If the UNSC were based on Gandhi's principles, the world would have been happier: Patel

In October 1948, then-Deputy Prime Minister Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel addressed officers and members of the Royal Indian Air Force. Patel highlighted the importance of adopting India's national language to shed the remnants of past slavery and bondage. He noted that while South Indians in the Congress and assemblies were making great efforts, language barriers still forced occasional use of foreign languages. Patel stated that he considered himself a soldier rather than a statesman or a politician after joining the newly emancipated armed forces.

ThePrint

GS2 From the Opinions Editor | America, Israel and an unsettled question: Can war win elections?

Ongoing global conflicts involving Israel and America raise critical questions about how war impacts domestic election outcomes. An editorial discussion examining the complex relationship between military conflicts and electoral success for political leaders in the United States and Israel.

Indian Express

GS1 Tattoos, piercings, hair colour: The absolute joy and terror of presenting queer

External markers like tattoos, piercings, and hair colour have become central symbols of LGBT+ self-expression and queer identity. These bodily alterations often serve as objects of rebellion against heteronormative societal expectations imposed at home and in schools. Journalist Ekta Sonawane used blue hair to assert commitment to Ambedkarite politics, showing how personal style merges with political stance. For many queer individuals, modifying bodies is a refusal to treat them as pristine temples, turning them instead into playful canvases.

ThePrint

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Knowledge Nugget | India's UNESCO Tentative List gets new sites: What you must know for UPSC Exam The inclusion of new sites on the UNESCO Tentative List brings them into the spotlight for UPSC exam aspirants. India has added new sites to its UNESCO Tentative List, highlighting potential future nominees for World Heritage status.

Indian Express

RBI likely to raise rates: Why inflation, crude and global rates matter The upcoming monetary policy review has put the focus on potential interest rate hikes by the RBI. An explanation of why the Reserve Bank of India is likely to raise interest rates, driven by domestic inflation pressures, global crude prices, and international monetary tightening.

Indian Express

Appointing the Election Commission: An Expert Explains why perception matters The topic is in the news via an Indian Express explainer examining the ongoing discussions around the appointment mechanism of election commissioners. This explainer details the process of appointing members to the Election Commission of India and analyzes why public perception of its independence remains vital for democracy.

Indian Express

Explainer: Who are the Houthis, Iran's allies in Yemen? Yemen's Saudi-backed government launched a military counteroffensive against the Iran-backed Houthis to seize territory under their control. Renewed fighting between the Houthis and Saudi Arabia reignited Yemen's civil war and increased risks to Red Sea shipping and energy exports.

Economic Times

RBI MPC Meeting October 2026: Repo rate hike will be decided by these 5 factors The Reserve Bank of India's six-member Monetary Policy Committee is scheduled to meet from October 5 to 7, 2026, to review monetary policy. Expectations for a 25 basis point repo rate hike have grown, which would take the rate to 5.50% and mark the first increase since February 2023.

msn.com

Gyanesh Kumar row: Key takeaways from Kerala probe, protests against ECI and SIR The row and subsequent protests involving the ECI and a Kerala probe brought the issue into active public and media focus. This article explains the controversy involving Gyanesh Kumar, public and political protests against the Election Commission of India, and the takeaways from a Kerala probe.

Indian Express

China This Week | Rumours about Xi's health, US jets arrive in Taiwan, and more The developments were featured in the weekly news roundup on China. Recent reports cover rumours about Chinese leader Xi Jinping's health and the arrival of US fighter jets in Taiwan.

Indian Express

'Satyagraha' website launched by Rahul Gandhi: What is it? Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi launched a digital platform named 'Satyagraha' to map and consolidate protests across India. The platform aims to unite dispersed struggles of Gen Z, students, farmers, tribals, Dalits, and women fighting alone against injustice.

The Hindu

'Indians Live Longer Than Pakistanis': Decoding WHO Report On Causes Of Death & Global Life Expectancy The release of the new WHO report on global life expectancy and causes of death put the comparative health metrics in the news. The World Health Organization report examines global life expectancy data and causes of death, revealing that Indians live longer than Pakistanis.
News18

Explained: Row over Jr NTR and Janhvi Kapoor's 'Chuttamalle' song: AI video, reactions and action taken An unknown social media user created a sexually explicit and vulgar version of the song Chuttamalle using artificial intelligence. The controversy erupted when the fake and digitally altered clip depicting Janhvi Kapoor went viral on social media platforms.
deccanherald.com

France high school students' protest: What sparked violence, what's next Tens of thousands of students and supporters protested across France this week over dilapidated schools, classroom overcrowding, and teacher shortages. The protests began last week in poor Parisian suburbs like Aubervilliers and spread to over 1,200 high schools across the country.
msn.com

Why is El Niño warming the Pacific but causing drought in other areas? The recurring global climatic impacts of El Niño continue to draw attention as scientists analyze its role in causing droughts and weather extremes. El Niño is a climate cycle in the Pacific Ocean that causes unusual warming of sea surface temperatures and disrupts global weather systems.
Firstpost

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Let exchange rate act as shock absorber: IMF on Fed hike impact on India (Economy) Business Standard
- Kiribati Teachers Prepare Students For Digital Future Amid Limited Connectivity: UNESCO Report (Education) NDTV
- India holds talks with Russia, Ukraine on ending war: Jaishankar (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- RBI likely to raise repo rate in October 2026 as West Asia crisis fuels inflation risks (Economy) Mint
- Yemen presidency announces military drive to retake all Houthi territory (International Relations) Al Jazeera
- MPC meet: Economists expect RBI to begin rate-hiking cycle (Economy) IANS LIVE
- NITI Aayog | Work For Viksit Bharat (Governance & Policy) NITI Aayog
- EAM Jaishankar Stresses Cooperation Among Emerging and Middle Powers (International Relations) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- GVC integration, supply chain resilience, FTAs key to boost exports, high-end manufacturing: Deloitte India (Economy) Economic Times
- CAQM conducts Inspection Drive along Ring Road in Delhi to assess Road Dust and effectiveness of Road Cleaning Operations (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- SC raises concern over steep markups on cancer medicines by private hospitals (Health) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- Reforms aimed at empowering cotton farmers, enhancing transparency and strengthening India's cotton value chain to take centre stage (Agriculture & Allied) PIB
- Iran reviewing US response to diplomatic proposal presented at UN: Kazem Gharibabadi (International Relations) Economic Times
- Keralam govt. orders preliminary anti-corruption enquiry against CEC Gyanesh Kumar over corruption allegations (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Prime Minister pays homage to freedom fighter Shyamji Krishna Varma on his birth anniversary (History, Art & Culture) PIB
- Chennai's monsoon test (Disaster Management) The Hindu
- Port unions seek urgent measures to protect Indian seafarers on conflict routes (International Relations) BusinessLine
- India's ethanol opportunity is bigger than blending target (Economy) BusinessLine
- IG Defence plans trials of India's first private-sector micro-missile soon (Defence) Business Standard
- BRICS Environment Ministers unveil four compendiums on sustainable environmental practices (Environment & Ecology) DD News
- Election Commission SIR 2026: Meet 5 retired SC, HC judges on panel examining legality, impact on voters (Polity & Constitution) Livemint
- Beyond 'Vote Chori': Ten facts on SIR, electoral rolls and the Election Commission of India (Polity & Constitution) organiser.org
- India summons Pak envoy to register strong protest over continued facilitation of illegal cross-border infiltration (International Relations) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- Road injuries 10th leading cause for deaths in India: WHO report (Health) Times of India
- Pacific nations set climate red lines as Fiji hosts COP31 briefing (Environment & Ecology) The Climate Watch
- Weekly News Wrap: Hyundai Eyes Third Plant, CAFE III Notified, EV Sales Hit Record (Economy) Autocar Professional
- Why Maharashtra's Green India Mission saplings died: CAG lists the failures (Environment & Ecology) The Indian Express
- State Visit of the President of Seychelles to India (February 05 - 10, 2026) (International Relations) Ministry of External Affairs
- Extended eco-tourism season in UP's Terai tiger reserves raises ecological concerns for grassland wildlif (Environment & Ecology) The Times of India
- Right to vote in great peril: Justice Rohinton Nariman flags executive interference in Election Commission (Polity & Constitution) Bar & Bench

- Can't Have An Election Commission Which Malfunctions Like This; Supreme Court Must Decide CEC Case Soon : ... (Polity & Constitution) Live Law
- Can Employers Act Against Employees for Illegal Strikes? Supreme Court Clarifies (Polity & Constitution) The Law Observer
- Financial Sector Restoration Has Been Key to India’s Economic Resilience: Shaktikanta Das (Economy) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- Supreme Court Upholds High Court's Quashing of Regularisation Notifications for Contractual Employees in Haryana. The Court held that Notifications issued by the State of Haryana in 2014 for regularising contractual, ad hoc, and daily wage employees were (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- BRICS, global changes and Sri Lanka’s choices (International Relations) The Morning
- RBI MPC Meeting Oct 2026 Live: Will the RBI increase repo rate? (Economy) BusinessLine
- Trade tensions flare as G20 fails to agree on overcapacity (International Relations) IOL
- Pakistan Army’s Drone MoU With US Firm Powerus Triggers Concerns Over Ukraine Drone Tech Transfer and Terror Links (International Relations) Defence.in
- Afghan Defense Ministry delegation participates in Russia's 2026-Center strategic military exercise (International Relations)
- NGT Cracks Down On Bhopal Waste Dumping, Orders Speedy Disposal After Two Agencies Failed To Clear Legacy (Environment & Ecology) Free Press Journal
- Goyal urges WTO-consistent action on trade distortions at G20 (International Relations) Fibre2Fashion
- Leopard populations decline in parts of Odisha: WII study (Environment & Ecology) The Siasat Daily
- Attempt By JPC To Meet Supreme Court Judges Was 'Shocking': Former SC Judges (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- UPSC Ethics Simplified | Civic Virtue on Indian roads: What does it say about us? (Ethics & Integrity) Indian Express
- ‘Uncertainty now a standing condition of international economy’, says finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman; highlights India's economic resilience (Economy) Hindustan Times
- 'Russia stood by us when our territorial integrity was under threat': Jaishankar in Munich (International Relations) Times of India
- From ‘Last villages’ to ‘first villages’: How the Vibrant Villages Programme is reshaping India’s border frontier (Governance & Policy) organiser.org

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 15 must-know, 24 Prelims facts, 47 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (11), International Relations (8), Governance & Policy (6), Economy (4), Defence (3), Science & Technology (3), Environment & Ecology (2), Infrastructure & Energy (1), Agriculture & Allied (1). **Nothing today in —** Social Justice & Welfare, Health, Education, Internal Security, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 2 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: nothing today · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 37 of 66 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — Indian Express 7, Economic Times 6, The Hindu 6, msn.com 4, BusinessLine 4, Mint 4, PIB 3, Lawtext 2, Hindustan Times 2, newsonair.gov.in 2, Deccan Herald 2, ThePrint 2, gktoday.in 1, timesofindia.indiatimes.com 1

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